INCH-POUND

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29 December 1988
SUPERSEDING
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21 February 1985

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BACON, SLICED, PRECOOKED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers sliced, precooked bacon in cans.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495 - Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8905

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MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications for Fresh Pork, Series 400

(Copies are available from the Director, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2092, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairman, Condition of Food Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 0608, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Suite 1120, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Pork bellies. The bellies shall be fresh (not previously frozen), unformed, rind-on bellies weighing not less than 8 nor more than 14 pounds. The belly shall be separated from the fat back on a straight line not more than 1.5 inches beyond the outermost curvature of the scribe line. The anterior and posterior edges shall be at approximately right angles to the ventral and dorsal edges. The teat line (or evidence thereof) must be present. The distance between the lattismus dorsi muscle and the pectoralis profundi shall be not greater than 1 inch on the shoulder end. The bellies must be recognizable; for example, those which, when compared to Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPS) cuts, have no more than a minor amount of lean, fat, or bone removed or included from an adjacent cut. The bellies shall be in the fresh-chilled state and shall be in excellent condition, i.e., exposed lean and fat surfaces shall be of a color and bloom normally associated with the class and grade of bellies, and typical of bellies which have been properly stored and handled. Cut surfaces and naturally exposed lean surfaces shall show no more than slight darkening or discoloration due to dehydration, aging, or microbial activity. The fat shall show no more than a slight discoloration due to oxidation or microbial activity. No odors foreign to fresh pork shall be present. The pork shall show no evidence of freezing, defrosting, or mishandling. Bellies derived from coarse-textured, dark pork, or pale, soft, and exudative (PSE) pork are not acceptable. Alternatively, skinless bellies may be used provided they weigh not less than 7 pounds nor more than 12.5 pounds, except that the teat line shall not be present. The rectus abdominus muscle shall be present.

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3.2.1.1 Boning and trimming. Bellies shall be made boneless and trimmed to comply with the limitations listed in table II and III. All pork bellies shipped between plants shall be accompanied by a USDA, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) certificate to certify condition of the product and compliance with boning and trimming requirements.

3.2.1.2 Handling and storage. Handling and storage of the boned and trimmed bellies, prior to processing into the finished product, shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Pork processed on the day of initial certification shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 50°F, inclusive.

b. Holding in the fresh-chilled state for not more than 4 days after initial certification is permitted, provided that the pork is maintained in the temperature range of 28° to 40°F, inclusive.

c. Holding in the frozen state for not more than 45 days after initial certification is permitted, provided that the pork is:

- frozen in 0°F or lower within 72 hours after initial certification
- stored at 0°F or lower
- protected from freezer deterioration and damage
- stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence.

d. Tempering/thawing of the frozen pork shall comply with the following:

- microwave tempering/thawing of frozen pork shall not be permitted
- frozen pork shall be tempered/thawed to a temperature not to exceed 40°F
- the time from the start of the tempering/thawing process (removal from freezer) to further preparation shall not exceed 96 hours
- pork which has been tempered/thawed shall not be refrozen.

3.2.2 Other ingredients. All other ingredients, such as frying fat and antioxidants, shall be in accordance with the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations. Frying fat, if used, shall be rendered pork fat or hydrogenated vegetable fat or oil with or without antioxidants.

3.2.3 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.3 Preparation and processing.

3.3.1 Belly preparation. Boned and trimmed pork bellies which meet the requirements of 3.2.1.1 shall be further trimmed, if necessary, to assure compliance with finished product requirements (see 3.6).

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3.3.2 Belly curing and smoking. The bellies shall be cured and smoked to produce slabs that have a well smoked appearance and aroma. The cured and smoked slabs shall be moderately firm or firmer.

3.3.3 Slab pressing and slicing. The cured and smoked slabs shall be pressed (formed) and mechanically sliced at 12 to 15 slices per pound.

3.3.4 Cooking. Cooking shall be accomplished by any acceptable commercial method which yields uniform, untangled slices that are not less than 4.5 inches in length. In addition, the cooked slices shall not be overcooked (brittle) or have burnt edges or areas and shall not be cut or torn.

3.4 Can filling and sealing. Each can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with whole slices of cooked bacon and sealed to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Prior to filling three hundred whole slices of cooked bacon into the can size 603 by 700, fifteen slices of bacon shall be placed (slice edges abutting) on a sheet of vegetable parchment, parchment, or commercial-style paper.

b. Prior to filling seventy-five whole slices of cooked bacon into the can size 401 by 411, at least eight slices of bacon shall be placed (slice edges abutting) on a sheet of vegetable parchment, parchment, or commercial-style paper.

c. For both can sizes, the commercial paper shall possess greaseproof and wet-strength characteristics. The sheets of bacon shall be neatly layered, rolled, and placed into the can with the length of the slices parallel with the depth dimension of the can.

d. Immediately after filling, each can shall be hermetically sealed under a vacuum of not less than 20 inches of mercury.

3.5 Can cleaning. The filled and sealed cans shall not be heat processed, but may be washed with hot water or steam to remove external grease.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

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d. There shall be no glandular tissue measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.

e. There shall be no bone piece, cartilage, skin, or bruises measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.

f. Slices shall not break or crack when the ends are brought together.

g. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

h. The average total slice count shall be 300 or 75 slices, as applicable.

i. No individual can shall contain less than 297 or 74 bacon slices, as applicable.

3.6.1 Water activity. No individual sample shall have a water activity value exceeding 0.840. The calculated mean water activity ($\bar{X}$) of the sample values shall not exceed 0.840. The unbiased standard deviation(s) for the calculated mean shall not exceed the value specified in table I. For calculated means lying between the tabular values, use the next higher tabular value.

TABLE I. Water activity values

Calculated Mean ($\bar{X}$)	Maximum unbiased standard deviations
0.840	0.0000
0.835	0.0013
0.830	0.0026
0.825	0.0039
0.820	0.0052
0.815	0.0066
0.810	0.0079
0.805	0.0092
0.800	0.0105
0.795	0.0118
0.790	0.0131
0.785	0.0144
0.780	0.0157
0.775	0.0171
0.770	0.0184
0.765	0.0197

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TABLE I. Water activity values (cont'd)

Calculated Mean ($\overline{X}$)	Maximum unbiased standard deviations
0.760	0.0210
0.755	0.0223
0.750	0.0236
0.745	0.0249
0.740	0.0262
0.735	0.0276
0.730	0.0289
0.725	0.0302
0.720	0.0315
0.715	0.0328
0.710	0.0341
0.705	0.0354
0.700	0.0367
0.695	0.0381
0.690	0.0394
0.685	0.0407
0.680	0.0420
0.675	0.0433
0.670	0.0446
0.665	0.0459
0.660	0.0472
0.655	0.0486
0.650	0.0499
0.645	0.0512
0.640	0.0525
0.635	0.0538
0.630	0.0551
0.625	0.0564
0.620	0.0577
0.615	0.0591
0.610	0.0604
0.605	0.0617
0.600	0.0630

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3.6.2 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The pork component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Pork belly examination for condition and cut. All pork bellies shall be examined in the boneless state for conformance to the condition and cut requirements in 3.2.1. Any nonconforming pork bellies shall be rejected.

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4.5.1.2 Boned and trimmed belly examination. After boning and trimming and prior to any further processing or to any freezing, the bellies shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The lot size expressed as number of bellies shall be declared to the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent by the contractor. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of a declared lot, if, in his or her opinion, that portion may be out of compliance with any requirement. The sample unit shall be one uncured belly. The sample size shall be as specified in table II. Failure of the bellies to meet the acceptance criteria as indicated in table II shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Except for bellies rejected because of freezing, defrosting, or not being in excellent condition, the bellies may be reworked by the contractor and reoffered for examination. For reexamination, the sampling plan used shall be the one in table II designed for the next larger lot size than the one under which the lot was initially rejected. The belly shall not be reexamined more than one time.

TABLE II. Sampling plan for boned and trimmed bellies

Lot size (bellies)	Sample size (No. of sample units)	Defect categories			
		Major		Minor	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
150 or less	20	1	2	2	3
151 or 280	32	2	3	3	4
281 to 500	50	3	4	5	6
501 to 1200	80	5	6	7	8
1201 to 3200	125	7	8	10	11
Reinspection lots of 1201 to 3200	200	10	11	14	15

TABLE III. Boned and trimmed belly defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Belly separated from the fat back more than 1.5 inches beyond the outermost curvature of the scribe line

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TABLE III. Boned and trimmed belly defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
102		Anterior and posterior edges not approximately at right angles to the ventral and dorsal edges
103		Weight of rind-on bellies less than 8 or more than 14 pounds, or weight of skinless bellies less than 7 or more than 12.5 pounds, as applicable 3/
104		Teat line or rectus abdominus muscle not in evidence, as applicable
105		Presence of enlarged, soft porous, dark, or seedy mammary tissue (e.g., dark red, brown, black)
106		Presence of coarse-textured, dark pork, or pale, soft, and exudative (PSE) pork
107		Distance between the lattismus dorsi muscle and pectoralis profundi greater than 1 inch on the shoulder end
	201	Presence of snowball (back fat exposed through lean side) measuring 3.0 inches or more in any dimension (not applicable to area outside of scribe line)
	202	Presence of leaf, lumbar, or pelvic fat measuring 3.0 inches or more in any dimension and 0.3 inches in depth

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (for example, glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.

2/ Evidence of freezing or defrosting or product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the lot.

3/ The AMS agent may weigh as many bellies as necessary to ensure compliance with the weight requirement.

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4.5.1.3 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.1.4 Unfilled can inspection. Conformance of unfilled cans to the requirements specified in 5.1.1 shall be determined by examination of certificates of conformance or other valid documents. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the can lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation, or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 End item inspection. The inspection lot shall include only products produced in one workshift. The AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot a portion of the contractor's declared lot, if in his or her opinion that portion may be out of compliance with any of the requirements.

4.5.3.1 Product examination. The sample size shall be as indicated by table IV. The product shall be examined for defects listed in table V. Cans selected for examination must be free of damage.

TABLE IV. Sampling plan for product examination

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)		Defect categories			
			Major		Minor	
	Major	Minor	AC	RE	AC	RE
2 to 150	5	2	0	1	0	1
151 to 35000	5	8	0	1	1	2

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TABLE V. Product defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Less than 297 or 74 bacon slices, as applicable, in any individual can 2/
	201	Product not arranged on parchment paper or layered as specified

1/ Defects shall be scored once per sample unit.

2/ The lot shall be rejected if the average total slice count is less than 300 or less than 75 slices, as applicable.

4.5.3.2 Slice examination. The sample size shall be as indicated by table VI. The slices shall be examined for defects listed in table VII. Slices shall be selected proportionately from the cans used in the product examination or from the number of cans necessary to comply with the sample size.

TABLE VI. Sampling plan for slice examination

Lot size (cans)	Sample size (No. of cans)		Defect categories			
			Major		Minor	
	Major	Minor	AC	RE	AC	RE
501 to 1200	80	80	5	6	10	11
1201 to 3200	125	125	7	8	14	15
3201 to 10000	200	200	10	11	21	22
10001 to 35000	315	200	14	15	21	22
35001 or more	500	200	21	22	21	22

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TABLE VII. Slice defects 1/ 2/ 3/

Cateogory		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Presence of a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
102		Presence of cartilage measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
103		Burnt edge or burnt area measuring 0.3 nch or more in any dimension 4/
104		Slice which breaks or cracks when the ends are brought together
105		Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)
	201	Presence of skin measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
	202	Presence of bruises measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
	203	Presence of glandular tissue measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension
	204	Slice cut or torn more than 1/2 the width of the slice
	205	Slice less than 4.5 inches in length

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

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3/ The product shall be examined at a temperature of 70° to 80°F.

4/ A burnt edge is one in which the black color of carbonation is evident to the eye.

4.5.4 Recanning procedure. Bacon used for end item inspection may be recanned provided recanning is completed within 2 hours after opening of the cans. If the lot from which the cans were selected is accepted, then the recanned product may be included in a subsequent lot. Recanned sampled product from more than one acceptable lot may be combined into one or more lots.

4.5.5 Water activity testing. Six filled and sealed cans shall be randomly selected from each production lot and individually tested for water activity. The water activity shall be determined in an AMS laboratory in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists; Chapter: Vegetable Products, Processed; Method: Water Activity - Official First Action, using a Hygrodynamic hygrometer system or an equivalent instrument. The sample unit shall be the contents of a whole can and the bacon shall not be ground prior to analysis. Water activity values shall be reported to the nearest 0.001. Acceptance and rejection of the lot shall be in accordance with 3.6.1 and table I criteria. Any nonconformance shall be classified as a critical defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.6 Can vacuum examination. Five filled and sealed cans selected for the product examination (see 4.5.3.1) shall be examined for vacuum. The cans and contents shall be allowed to reach 70° to 80°F. The vacuum reading shall be taken with a puncture-type vacuum gage making the puncture as near as possible to the double seam to minimize error due to distortion of the end. A correction of 1 inch of vacuum shall be added to the gage reading for each 1000 feet above sea level at which the determination is made. Failure of any can to meet the vacuum requirement shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.7 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed cans shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that the inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4.1).

4.5.8 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

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Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified.
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.
Not snug-fitting or evidence of bulging.

Minor: Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

Level C shipping containers shall be examined for the marking, arrangement, and number of can defects specified above and for the closure method specified in 5.2.3.

4.5.9 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Three hundred whole slices of product shall be unit packed into a size 603 by 700 can or 75 whole slices of product shall be unit packed into a size 401 by 411 can when specified (see 6.1), and hermetically sealed under a vacuum of not less than 20 inches of mercury as specified in 3.4. The can shall be an open-top style, round metal can, with soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate. The base plate of the can shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. In addition, the cans shall be beaded to provide paneling resistance. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated with enamel. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I or, when specified (see 6.1), type II of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be preserved as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable. Alternatively, cans may be made from 0.20 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate provided the cans have an exterior commercial coating.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

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5.2.1 Level A packing. Six size 603 by 700 cans or twenty-four size 401 by 411 cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The size 603 by 700 cans shall be packed on end three in length, two in width, and one in depth, within a snug-fitting shipping container. The size 401 by 411 cans shall be packed on end four in length, three in width, and two in depth, within a snug-fitting shipping container. The tiered cans shall be separated by a full length and width fiberboard pad made of the same material as the box. The pads shall be not less than 1/8 inch of the full length and width interior dimensions of the box. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.1). When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Six size 603 and 700 cans or twenty-four size 401 by 411 cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Six size 603 by 700 cans or twenty-four size 401 by 411 cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, within a snug-fitting container in accordance with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except the closure of the fiberboard boxes shall be in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2.2 or 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. Paper labels are not permitted. The name of the product or abbreviation thereof and date of pack (month and year) shall be embossed or lithographed on the can. The label shall contain the following information:

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Precooked Bacon (Directions for use)

1. Open can at both ends and push out bacon. (For easy removal, place closed cans in hot water for a few minutes before opening.)

2. Invert each layer, bacon side down on a grill or baking sheet. Peel off paper.

3. Heat until bacon starts to crisp (350°F grill; 375°F oven). Do not overcook, as bacon is fully cooked.

CONTAINS: Approximately 100 servings or 25 servings (as applicable) of 3 slices per serving.

5.4.2 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The following precautionary marking placed on top of each container in capital letters larger than other markings shall be included:

HANDLE WITH CARE
CANS UNDER VACUUM

5.4.3 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).
e. Levels of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
f. When 300 slices or 75 slices per unit pack is required (see 5.1.1).
g. When type III exterior coating of cans is required (see 5.1.1).
h. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

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6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.4 Salt content of cured bellies. Bellies having a salt content of not less than 2.5 percent after curing have been known to meet the water activity requirements of 3.6.1.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canned foods
Pork bellies

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity

Army - GL

(Project 8905-B061)

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DP - SS

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-44158A	Bacon, Sliced, Precooked

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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